Workers' Management Groups Reinstated in a Shanghai Factory

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Precis, with quotations, of a report on the Shanghai watch and clock parts factory. "Cadres take part in labour, workers take part in management".

"Since June 1974, the cadres of various departments and offices of the Shanghai watch and clock parts factory have gone to workshops and teams to take part in collective productive labour while a number of workers have been selected to assume leading posts and take part in management work in various departments and offices by the factory." This system is much welcomed by cadres and workers of the factory. It promotes ideological revolutionization of the cadres and is an important step in combating and preventing revisionism. It has also whipped up the revolutionary enthusiasm of the cadres and masses. In 1974, although the total number of the factory's workers was reduced by 10%, output was 10% higher than in the previous year. The output during the first six months of this year again rose by 20% over the same period in 1974, and profits returned to the State went up by 42%.

During the cultural revolution, the workers of the factory organized workers' investigation groups to take part in the management of the factory and promote production. After the establishment of the factory's revolutionary committee, workers' investigation groups were dissolved.

"In the movement to criticize Lin Piao and Confucius, the workers exposed the contradictions in the light of the actual situation in the factory and criticized the work-style of some cadres of various departments and offices of the factory who had divorced themselves from the masses. The criticism by the masses has greatly inspired the factory's leadership. The factory's Party committee organized cadres to study conscientiously Marxist-Leninist works and Chairman Mao's works, vigorously criticize the reactionary programme of 'restraining oneself and restoring the rites' peddled by Lin Piao and Confucius and the idealist concept of history that 'the highest are the wise and the lowest are the stupid' and restudy the Constitution of the Anshan Iron and Steel Company personally inscribed by Chairman Mao. They were convinced that the workers' investigation groups were new-born things emerging as a result of the great proletarian cultural revolution and a good form of workers' participation in management work. They were further convinced that the workers' investigation groups should be restored and their fighting role further developed."

The factory's Party committee selected a number of workers and asked them to take part in management work. At the same time it organized cadres to go down to workshops and teams to take part in collective productive labour. Now the representatives of workers are recommended by the masses and they begin their management work after approval by the Party committee and after attending the study classes.

The cadres' participation in collective labour and workers' participation in management work in the factory has the following advantages: "(1) It eliminates different classes and grades, restricts bourgeois rights and closes the gap between physical and mental labour. (2) The workers take part in the management of various departments and offices of the factory. They grasp the direction and political line of the factory and supervise the enterprise in advancing along the socialist orientation. (3) The system promotes closer relations between the cadres and masses. (4) It will help the cadres to improve their work-style, see the actual situation and remould their world outlook. (5) It has cultivated a number of new worker-cadres."

"Recently, the factory's Party committee summed up the experiences in having cadres take part in collective productive labour and having workers take part in management work and further developed the system. Workers are now invited to take